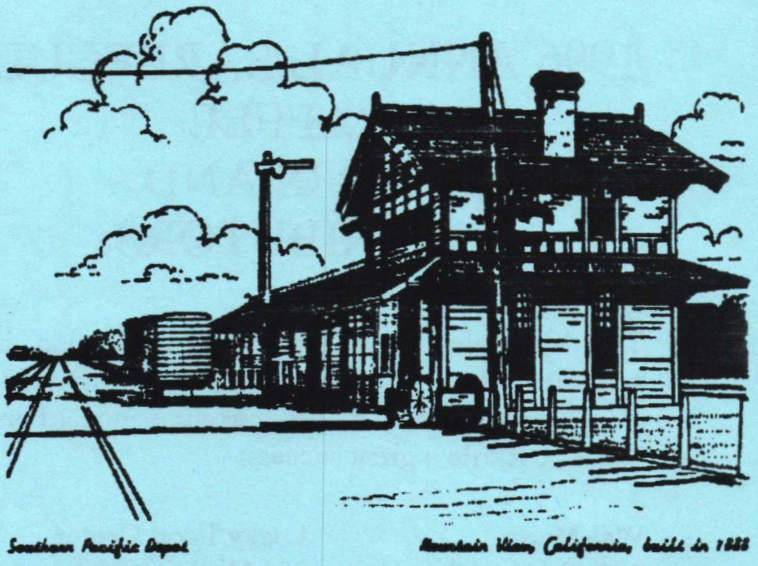
# MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION NEWSLETTER

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor




## LIFE AS A CREWMAN ON THE USS MACON
### The November Meeting

For 18 months the USS Macon (ZR5) was based here in the valley. What was it like to serve on board one of these huge ships? What were they like, inside and out? What were these great machines good for, and is there a place in the future for lighter-than-air?

Our speaker at the November 3, 1996 meeting is a co-founder and past president of the Moffett Field Historical Society and he will have with him as panelists two men who actually served on board the USS Macon.

Our speaker will of course be Ben DeBolt. He came to Mountain View from Southern California in 1954. He was a teacher in Palo Alto and a school principal in Mountain View until his retirement in 1983. He also retired that year from the US Naval Reserve as a Chief Warrant Officer, after 38 years of service. Ben is an active member and Past President of the Mountain View Historical Association and is currently working hard on the Save The Adobe Task Force.

Ben will be supported in his presentation by George Weldy and Pete Calande, both of whom served as crewmen on the USS Macon.

## BARBECUE & RAFFLE
### The August Meeting

The August meeting was the Annual Barbecue & Raffle for the Mountain View Historical Association. The location this year was the patio adjacent to our regular meeting room at the Mountain View Senior Center. The new area proved almost ideal for our group; big enough to move around, but compact enough for easy communication. The weather was ideal, the food was delicious, the raffle fun and the fellowship outstanding! Art Walton's potato salad is becoming a legend in its own right! Al Jehning demonstrated the touch of a master chef on the hamburgers! Mark you calendars now for Sunday, August 3, 1997 for the "Mountain View Historical Association Fourth Annual Barbecue & Raffle."

The success of the Barbecue & Raffle was due in no small part to the generosity of many businesses and individuals. You will find a list of these fine people and organizations inside. You will also note from the Treasurer's report that the Barbecue & Raffle made money!

**Don't forget to vote!
Elections are Tuesday,
November 6, 1996**

# 1996 ANNUAL BARBECUE & RAFFLE DONORS AND CONTRIBUTORS

The Mountain View Historical Association is grateful to the following businesses and individuals whose generosity helped make the annual Barbecue & Raffle a great success:

**Wal-Mart**
600 Showers Dr.
Paper Goods

**Lucky Food Center**
580 N. Rengstorff
$ 5.00

**Safeway**
2580 California St.
Apple Pies

**Nob Hill Market**
1350 Grant Road
$ 15.00

**Al Jehning**
561 Carla Ct.
Charcoal/Starter

**Tien Fu**
174 Castro Street
$10.00

**Safeway Bailey Plaza**
570 No. Shoreline
Ice Cream

**Michael's**
2960 Shoreline Blvd
$20.00

**Safeway**
1750 Miramonte
Salad

**Boston Market**
1039 El Monte
2 meals

**Lucky Food Center**
715 E. El Camino
Chili Beans

**See's Candies**
4844 El Camino, LA
Candy

**Casa de Fruta**
1040 N. Rengstorff
Vegetables

**Chili's**
2560 W. El Camino
$10.00

**Costco**
1000 N. Rengstorff
Buns/Meat

**Orchard Supply**
2555 Charleston
$50.00

**Golden Wok**
895 Villa
2 lunches

**Chevy's**
2116 W. El Camino
$25.00

# EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE MEETING
## September 18, 1996

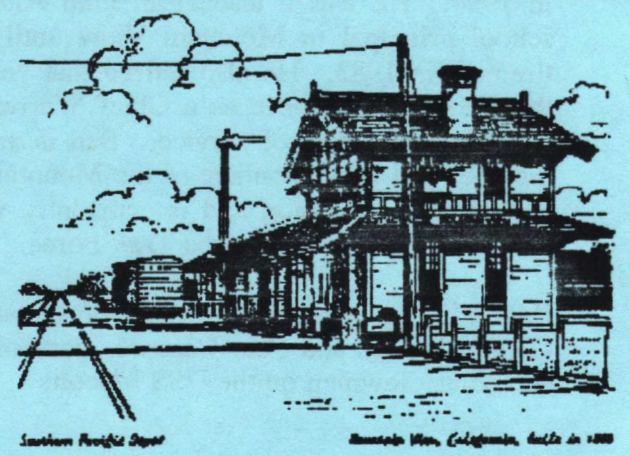
The Mountain View Historical Association Executive Committee met on September 18, 1996 in the Pioneer Room.

The Treasurer's report and a membership report are given elsewhere in this Newsletter. The Nominating Committee reported that they had completed their slate and that it would be presented in the Newsletter (see page 4).

Large numbers of persons are expected to visit the ***Anne Frank*** exhibit which will be housed on the fourth floor of City Hall, adjacent to the Pioneer Room. This may generate a substantial number of drop in visitors. Signage identifying the Pioneer Room has been requested.

The Committee voted to purchase protective sleeves for the photgraphs in the Pioneer Room. It is expected that we will be at least partially reimbursed by the Visual Arts Committee for this expense.

This will be the last meeting of this Executive Committee as the Biennium ends at the conclusion of the November annual meeting. Its been an excellent and hardworking team!



# SAVE THE ADOBE TASK FORCE

## MISSION STATEMENT

***The mission of the "Save the Adobe" Task Force is to restore and preserve Mountain View's historic Adobe Building for use as a vital community resource.***

### Task Force Main Committee

Wally Erichsen (Chair)
Ann Bakotich
Hilton Brown
Ben DeBolt
Eva Mockbee
Bob Schatz
Honor Spitz
Edna Thompson
Kassandra Winder

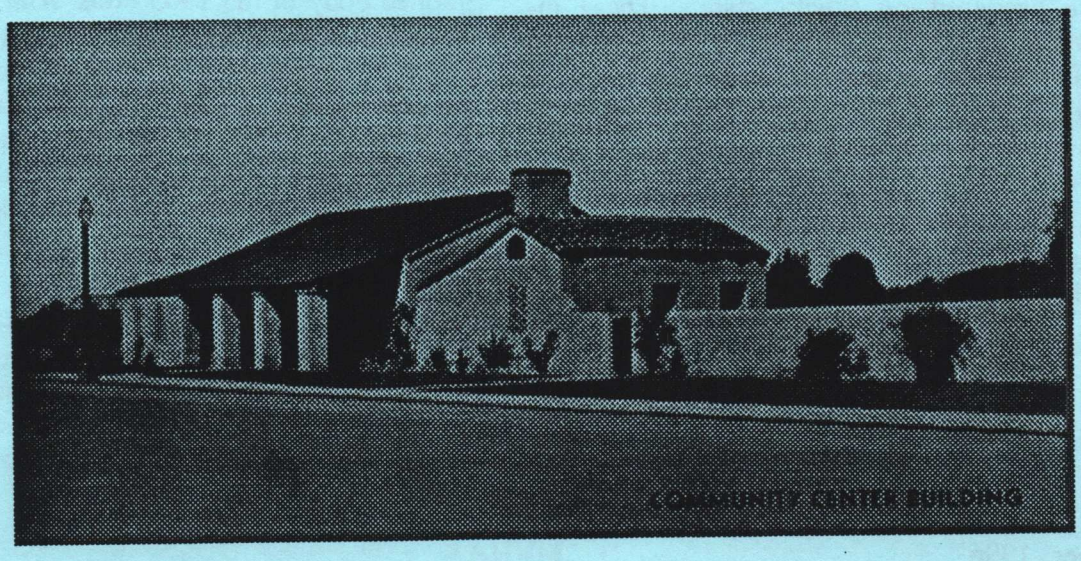
The Task Force meets on a regular monthly basis and ad hoc subcommittees meet as required. If you would like to join in the effort to ***Save the Adobe***, contact any of the committee members listed above.

The Committee has filed a progress report with the City Council indicating a substantial level of public interest in preserving the ***Adobe***. Nearly three hundred names of residents interested in preserving the ***Adobe*** have already been obtained.

Volunteers recruited by the Task Force participated in the Small Brewer's Festival, and Task Force members manned a booth at the Art and Wine Festival. The Task Force will participate in several more public events over the next few months.

The Task Force has established a "Speakers Bureau", and we can arrange for presentations to your organizations.

We welcome your ideas and participation. If we are to preserve the ***Adobe*** , it will require the support of the entire community. Anything you can do to help muster that support will be greatly appreciated.



# NEW TO THE PIONEER ROOM
## Reported by Barbara Kinchen

***From Lennart Ahlkvist*** - Small piece of marble (3½" x 6") which he picked up at Bank of America, then at 201 Castro Street, after the 1938 bombing of that building. Also from Lennart Ahlkvist, ten snapshots taken in August 1996 of the cannery cottages at Villa and Mountain View Avenue due to be torn down soon.

***From Joe Sweeney*** - Book *Hindenberg* - An illustrated history of the era of the great airships by Rick Arshbold. This beautiful book of 239 pages is filled with pictures and has one chapter about the Akron and Macon entitled Unlucky Pioneers.

***From Margaret Moore*** - Three scrapbooks from the estate of her late sister, Mrs. Ann Davyak Briski. They have pictures and information about Carpenters Union No. 1280 of Mountain View and the Ladies Auxiliary. One contains clippings, graduation and birth notices pertaining to the family.

***From Mr. C. Mortimer*** - A record book in which Fritz Campen kept information about rental of films for his Glen Theater. These show dates in 1913-1914, 1919 and 1920.

***From Art Walton*** - Several pictures from the Elda Frederickson Black estate. These include wedding pictures of Elda Fredrickson and Ernest Black in 1941 and pictures and letters of Elizabeth Taylor, of Mountain View, when serving as a missionary in Burma.

***From Eva Mockbee*** - Newspaper clippings of Mountain View's 85th Birthday celebration and dedication of Eagle Park, ribbons from City parades, 1928 Block "M" from MVUHS and a picture of the J.H. Mockbee & Son Plumbing Shop at 542 Dana Street. Jack Mockbee had this constructed in 1927 just next to his Dana Street home.

*(continued in next column)*

# MVHA 1996 ELECTIONS
## Nominating Committee Report

It is time to elect officers for the 1997/1998 biennium. In accordance with our bylaws, at the August regular meeting we elected a nominating committee, consisting of Hilton Brown (Chair), Barbara Kinchen and June de Larios.

The Nominating Committee feels that the current officers have done an outstanding job, and that the Association will be very well served if they continue in office. The Committee therefor submits the following slate to serve terms beginning at the adjournment of the November 1996 meeting and continuing through the November 1998 meeting.

| | |
|---|---|
| **President** | ***Ralph Faravelli*** |
| **Vice President** | ***Arthur Walton*** |
| **Secretary** | ***Eva Mockbee*** |
| **Treasurer** | ***June de Larios*** |

The bylaws specify that nominations for each office may be made from the floor at the annual meeting. Therefor, if you are a member of the Mountain View Historical Association and would like to nominate someone else for any of the Association offices, feel free to do so.

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***From Pauline Gibson Bennett*** - Autographed copy of the 1965 book *Wild White Wings* by Emily Watson Hallin, of Los Altos Hills, and Robert Kingery Buell, Mountain View. Bob Buell was the invalid son of Rev. and Mrs. Albert S. Buell of the Methodist Church and authored many books for both adults and children. For many years he had a regular newspaper column in the Register-Leader.

***From Jack and Betty(Lamico) Evans-*** Two pieces from the front of the 1924-1987 Mountain View High School on Castro Street: a portion of one of the pillars and chunk of the "Senior Steps." Jack and Betty are grads of the school.

# MOUNTAIN VIEW'S MODEL CANNERY

## By Candace Bowers

Among the many fruit canning plants that once operated locally, one was praised as a "model cannery" that had the latest machinery, met the highest sanitary regulations, and provided for the well-being of its employees. This cannery, J.W. McCarthy Jr. and Co., was located on Villa Street just west of Shoreline Blvd., near the railroad tracks.

J.W. McCarthy Jr. bought the cannery in 1917 from the Sanguinetti family, who had started the cannery about a dozen years earlier but apparently lacked the capital to keep the business growing and expand. This included building a housing complex for his employees, which was known as the Rose Court cottages.

A 1920 photograph of the Rose Court cottages shows neat, one-story bungalows grouped around well-manicured lawns and connected by clean, white sand paths. Employees' children had their own playground that was presided over by a full-time "matron." The complex also had its own superintendent and boasted of the latest, most efficient electrical, water and bathing facilities. It was hoped that such comfortable living quarters would ensure the "respectability and high morale" of the residents.

The cannery was an important factor in the local economy. The operation supported hundreds of men and women on its payroll, which at the peak of the season could mean $10,000 a week paid to workers. It was thought that these busy workers spent most of their money locally. The plant also had a large expenditure for raw materials. In one year they bought 2,000 tons of tomatoes at $12-$21.50 per ton; 400 tons of apricots at $100-$405 per ton; 330 tons of Firestone and cling peaches, which ranged from $55 to $110 a ton; 100 tons of pears at $100 a ton; and 100 tons of apples at $14 a ton, to name several crops. This produce was brought from local orchardists, who were also thought, or hoped, to spend their earnings locally. It was canned and sold under such names as Bountiful, Valley Belt, Tallac and Fair Play. Overall, the cannery was such a successful business that one writer of the time predicted that it would "eventually be one of the greatest canning plants in the entire country."

*(continued in next column)*

Although today there is nothing left of the J.W. McCarthy cannery, the Rose Court cottages remain. They are located on Villa Street at the corner of Mountain View Avenue. The sandy paths have been replaced by concrete, and the wooden porches and other trimmings have disappeared over the years. But they still give a sense of how closely the cannery employees lived and worked.

# IN MEMORIUM

*Doris May*, died in March 1996. Survived by husband Art. Doris was a long-time member of the Historical Association, a 1931 grad of Mountain View High School and daughter of the late Sam P. and Bertha Miller.

# Letter from George D. Jagels

I was reading the article by Carol Fischer in the Association Newsletter concerning the Women's Club. I was interested to see the reference to the old building. It might be interesting to the readers of your paper to know that the Women's Club building that was there when I lived in Mountain View was a former Methodist Church. At the time there had been two Methodist Churches, one was known as the Northern and the other the Southern. It seems that during the Civil War there was enough feeling in the area about slavery that members of the church separated their places of worship. The building to which I refer was the Southern Methodist Church.

# OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS
## Noted by Barbara Kinchen

***100 YEARS AGO (1896):*** Walker Jones took over as editor of the Mountain View Register and outlined his policy for the paper as follows: "we shall wax eloquent in describing the resources of Mountain View and vicinity, and enthusiastically inform the world of every improvement made in the village. When your friends die we will waft them to the other shore with words of comfort and sympathy to the bereaved, we will compose sad requiems to be engraved upon there tombs. We shall burst forth with warbling of poetry when you get married, and welcome your new born into the world with all the pomp imaginable, just as if he or she were going to be a Daniel Webster or Susan B. Anthony in the future. We shall kick at the supervisors and county officers just to please you though they be pretty good men. We shall write some powerful editorials on the great economic questions of the day, wrestle with the tariff, criticize the Alaska sealing commission, pull the British Lion's tail, rip him up the back and walk over his mangled fragments."

***75 YEARS AGO (1921):*** McDonald and Burke, one of the last remaining blacksmith shops in the county and the last in Mountain View, is busy morning to night six days a week.

"You'll never get up in the world by being down in the mouth."

Merchants held Dollar Day sales to coincide with the Seventh Annual Prune and Apricot Exposition. The three-day affair included exhibits of farm and garden products, parade, carnival, grand ball, races and contests, special street lighting and decorations and an auto and tractor show.

"Hearse Kicked Back, Broke Undertaker's Arm." When Wm. J. Anway went to Pearson's Garage to pick of his hearse , the crank kicked back as he was starting the engine and both bones were fractured in the right forearm.

The Parisian Bakery became a "cash-only" business. Hot bread was available all day and sold at 10¢ for a 1½ pound loaf.

Abram J. Knight and son Robert, of San Francisco, have purchase from Dr. Wm N. Kennedy the stock of drugs, soda fountain, candy and all fixtures at 169 Castro Street.

***50 YEARS AGO (1946):*** Mountain View Theater was showing Gary Cooper and Ingrid Bergman in Saratoga Trunk. Ladies received free pottery Wednesday evenings and kids got pictures of Roy Rogers at the Saturday matinee.

Enrollment in grammar schools was up as much as 25% over 1945 with 262 pupils at Dana Street School, 924 at Highway School and 100 at Miramonte, the Adventist school at 1500 Villa Street.

Food City celebrated its sixth anniversary.

Santa Clara County's 1946 prune crop totaled 200,000 tons of the purple fruit, gathered by 20,000 pickers from 56,115 acres of land.

Anderson Brothers, local housemovers, took the Memorial Baptist Church from the south west corner of Hope and Dana Streets to its new home on Church Street at Ehrhorn. The structure had been unused since it was damaged by fire in May.

City Council has ordered that parking meters be installed on Castro Street.

No longer in operation is the United Servicemen's Club. It has entertained thousands of men in uniform during the years in the Adobe Building.

A medical center is being constructed on Hope Street near Dana for Dr. R.T. Glyer, Dr. C.H. Glyer and Dr. J.L. Anderson.

# MEMBERSHIP REPORT

As of October 1, 1996

## Reported by Edna Thompson

A list of all members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Below is a tally by class of membership, and the names of new members.

| | |
|---|---|
| Life Members | 42 |
| Special Members | 2 |
| Honored Member | 1 |
| Individual Members | 111 |
| Family Memberships | 61 |
| Total Memberships | 201 |
| Total Members | 262 |

New Members (Since last Newsletter)

Life Members: Ralph Faravelli
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson

Members: Anthony J. Radicich
E. Gerald Hall
Shirley March

## Life Members

(Those marked * are new life members in 1996)

Mario Ambra*
Lawrence Anderson*
Lorena Anderson
Dena K. Bonnell
Reynolds Camp
Cliff Del Carlo
Ruth Erichsen*
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Faravelli
Ralph Faravelli*
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson*
Charles Hirschbek*
DeWitt Hogle
Norene Hogle*
George Holden
George Jagels
Al Jehning
John W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Holly Urban Moore Leonard*
Kenneth Richard Malova*
Madeline Chargon Malova*
Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore
Mimi Mourkas
Patricia J. Reyburn
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Martin J. Spangler
Honor Spitz
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson
Sally Moore Taboada*
John Viscovich
Bill Wissell

# ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND BOARD

| | |
|---|---|
| President | Ralph Faravelli |
| Past President & Social | Wally Erichsen |
| Vice President & Program | Arthur Walton |
| Secretary | Eva Mockbee |
| Treasurer | June de Larios |
| Membership | Edna Thompson |
| Newsletter & Publicity | Hilton Brown |
| Hospitality | Mary Esther Walton |
| Memorials/Rememberances | Edna Thompson |
| Ways & Means | Joseph Sweeney |
| Historical Data | Barbara Kinchen |
| Amplification & Recording | Albert Jehning |

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics, submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

# TREASURER'S REPORT

July 1, 1996 - September 30, 1996

## Treasurer A.J. de Larios

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Balance 7/1/96** | | $7,163.74 |
| **Income:** | | |
| Membership | $338.00 | |
| Adobe fund | 74.00 | |
| Interest | 13.10 | |
| Barbecue | 956.00 | |
| Sales | 42.00 | |
| **Total Income:** | | 1,423.10 |
| **Expenses:** | | |
| Administration | $ 16.31 | |
| Newsletter | 214.15 | |
| Barbecue | 133.73 | |
| **Total Expensis:** | | 364.19 |
| **Balance 9/30/96** | | $8,222.65 |
| **Fund Balances 9/30/96** | | |
| Adobe Fund | $1,664.04 | |
| Memorial Fund | 75.00 | |
| Life Member Fund | 4,200.00 | |
| General Fund | 2,283.61 | |
| Total Funds: | | $8,222.65 |

# MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

***Regular Meeting***

Sunday, November 3, 1996 - 2:00 PM

Senior Center - 266 Escuela

*Topic and Speakers*

## Life Aboard The Macon

## A Presentation By

## Ben DeBolt

*with*

***George Weldy and Pete Calande***

## MEMBERSHIP

Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

**AIMS** The aims of this Association are: To gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places. To cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

### MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME _____

ADDRESS _____

_____

TELEPHONE _____

NEW ___ RENEWAL ___ Regular Membership $7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr - Life Membership $100.00
Make Check Payable and mail to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

**Mountain View**
**Historical Association**
**P.O. Box 252**
**Mountain View, CA 94042**







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